

Practicum No.12**Date: 13/3/2026****People Plan Preparation****I. Practical Significance**

This practicum equips learners with the The People Plan Preparation which plays a crucial role in helping learners understand how to strategically design and manage human resources within a startup environment. It equips students with the ability to align organizational structure, talent acquisition, and role allocation with the company's vision and mission. By engaging in this practicum, students learn to anticipate workforce requirements, build effective teams, and foster a culture of innovation and accountability. They learn to design comprehensive people plan that address recruitment, retention, leadership development, and succession strategies.

Through this practicum, students develop strategic thinking skills by analyzing how the right people and skills drive startup growth and investor confidence. The practicum also guides learners in creating a compelling pitch deck by integrating people strategy elements such as leadership strength, team competence, and organizational culture—into the business presentation. This hands-on experience enables learners to translate concepts into actionable strategies that directly impact startup scalability and sustainability.

II. Competency and Industry-Specific Practical Skills

This practicum exercise is expected to develop the following skills for the industry-identified competency.

- **Develop** a pitch deck, project proposals for small/medium scale startups logically and scientifically *(As stated in the Course Structure)*
 - a) **Assess** the vision, mission, and strategic goals for a startup. *(CDO)*
 - b) **Evaluate** strategic management frameworks to align goals with organizational values. *(CDO)*
 - c) **Function** as an effective team leader and collaborator in planning exercises. *(ADO)*
 - d) **Prepare** structured business planning documents. *(PDO)*

III. Relevant CO(s)*(As stated in the Course Structure)*

- **CO4. Design** a suitable business model and formulate financial plans for the selected product/service.

IV. Practical Outcome (PrO)*(As stated in the Course Structure)*

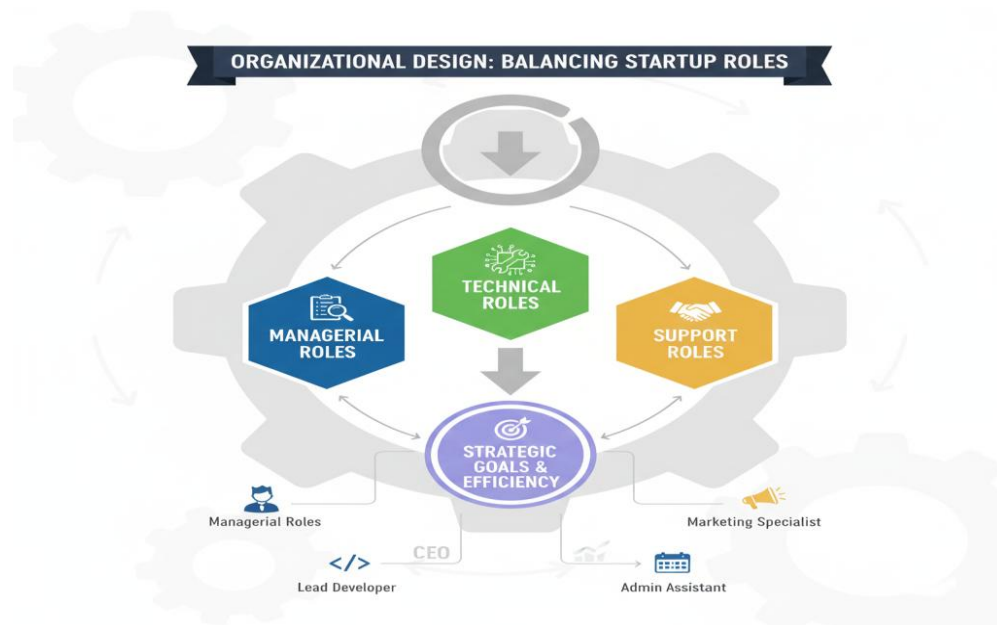
- **Identify** required roles for the venture (e.g., Embedded Engineer, FPGA Specialist, Business Development Manager, QA Lead).

V. Related ADO(s) *(As stated in the Course Structure)*

- a) **Perform** as an effective team leader.
- b) **Function** as a cooperative team member.
- c) **Demonstrate** ethical decision-making and critical thinking in business planning.
- d) **Exhibit** professionalism in documentation and presentation standards.

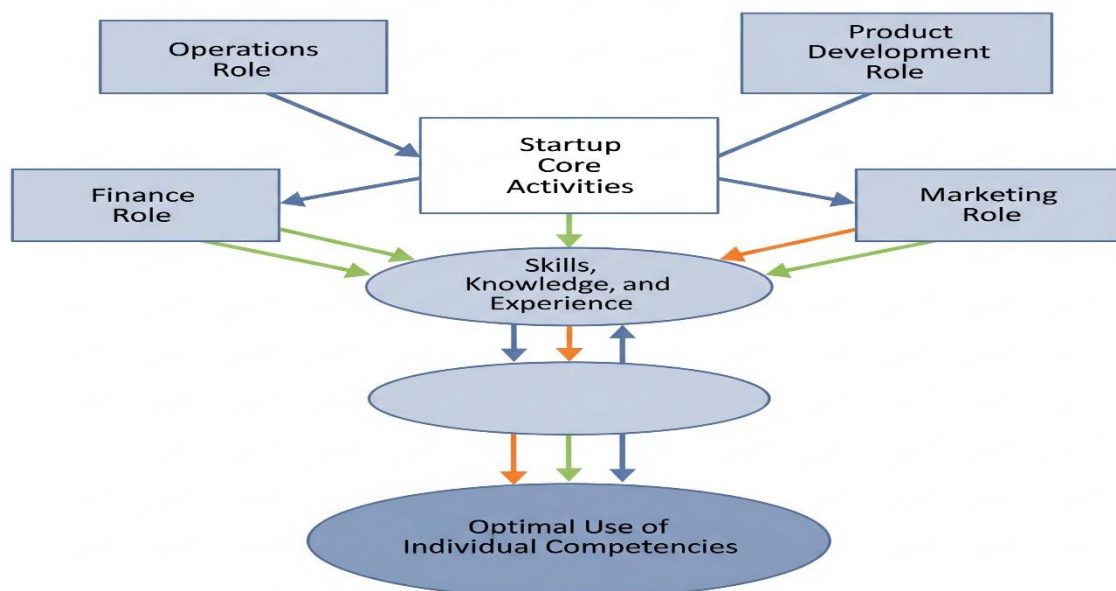
VI. Minimum Underpinning Theory *(Include relevant content & images for this practicum.)*

Identifying required roles for a venture is grounded in organizational design theory, which emphasizes structuring human resources to align with strategic goals and operational efficiency. According to organizational framework, startups must define roles that balance managerial, technical, and support functions to ensure smooth workflow and accountability. This theory supports the idea that each role contributes uniquely to achieving the venture's mission and vision. By applying this framework, entrepreneurs can design lean, adaptable teams that respond effectively to market changes and growth demands.



The process also draws from human capital theory, which highlights the value of skills, knowledge, and experience as critical assets in building a competitive startup. Identifying roles involves analyzing the venture's core activities—such as product development, marketing, finance, and operations—and assigning responsibilities accordingly. This theoretical approach ensures optimal use of individual competencies while minimizing redundancy and role ambiguity. As a result, startups can cultivate a balanced workforce structure that promotes innovation, efficiency, and sustainable business performance.

Human Capital Theory





VII. Practicum Set-up/Circuit Diagram/Algorithm/Flowchart *(Include probable photos of experimental set-up.)*

The following algorithm details the logical, step-by-step process for developing a people plan:



PEOPLE PLAN

BLUEPRINT FOR AGILE STARTUP
GROWTH & INNOVATION



VIII. Resources Required

S. No.	Resource	Suggested Broad Specification	Quantity
1	Computer/Laptop	MS Office/Google Docs, Canva/PowerPoint	1
2	Reference Material	Case studies of successful startups, vision/mission templates, industry reports	1
3	Internet Access	For researching industry trends, competitor analysis, startup examples	2
4	Projector/Screen	For presentation of venture blueprint	3
5	Whiteboard/Flipcharts	For brainstorming and collaborative planning sessions	4

IX. Safety Precautions

- Ensure** that all statements reflect ethical, realistic, and socially responsible objectives.
- Avoid** copying vision/mission statements from existing enterprises; originality is essential.
- Maintain** confidentiality of startup ideas, proprietary information, or sensitive business data.
- Use** professional formatting, grammar, and appropriate business language in all documents.
- Respect** intellectual property rights when referencing external sources or case studies.

X. Procedure(Self-Instructional)

1. **Choose** a startup needing a people plan.
2. **Research** similar startups for role and structure.
3. **Draft** an organizational chart with key functions.
4. **Frame** roles with required skills and competencies.
5. **Set** short-, medium-, and long-term staffing goals.
6. **Validate** the plan using SMART criteria.
7. **Apply** tools like RACI or Competency Mapping.
8. **Prepare** a manpower blueprint with clear responsibilities.
9. **Design** visual charts showing team roles clearly.
10. **Present** plan, gather feedback, then improve.

XI. Actual Resources Used

S. No.	Name of Resource	Broad Specifications		Quantity	Remarks (If any)
		Make	Details		
1.	Laptop	ASUS	Windows OS, 8GB RAM used for preparing the people plan document	1	N/A
2.	Internet	Wi-Fi	Used for researching startup team structures and templates	1	N/A
3.	Browser	Chrome	Used to access online references and templates	1	N/A
4.	Templates	Miro	Organizational chart and role mapping templates used for team planning	1	N/A

XII. Actual Procedure Followed

1. Selected **Digital Attendance and Productivity Tracker** as the startup idea for preparing the people plan.
2. Studied the concept of a **startup people plan**, including identifying roles, responsibilities, and organizational structure.
3. Researched similar **software-based startups and digital education platforms** to understand common team structures.
4. Created an **organizational structure chart** using a template to represent the hierarchy of the startup team.
5. Identified key roles required for the project such as **Software Developer, UI/UX Designer, Data Analyst, Business/Marketing Manager, and Testing/Support Engineer**.
6. Defined the **responsibilities and required skills for each role** to ensure proper task distribution.
7. Planned the **team growth strategy**, including short-term, medium-term, and long-term staffing requirements as the startup expands.
8. Applied the **SMART framework** to ensure that the hiring and team planning goals were realistic and achievable.
9. Used simple planning tools such as **competency mapping** to match team members' skills with project responsibilities.
10. Compiled all information into a **structured people plan document** showing roles, responsibilities, team structure, and growth plan.

XIII. Observations

S.No.	Step in Practicum	Case studies/LMS analytics/rubrics for Team works /Instructor Evaluation Forms	Observation Details	Remarks
1	Startup Idea Selection	Digital Attendance and Productivity Tracker selected for people planning	Practical educational technology solution	Startup Idea Selection
2	Research	Studied team structures of educational software startups	Helped identify necessary roles	Research
3	Role Identification	Roles defined for development, design, business, and support	Balanced startup team	Role Identification
4	Skill Mapping	Skills aligned with responsibilities using competency mapping	Efficient team planning	Skill Mapping

XIV. Results/Observations

The people plan for the **Digital Attendance and Productivity Tracker** successfully identified the essential roles and responsibilities required for the startup. The organizational structure ensures coordination between technical development, design, business management, and system support activities. This structured team plan supports efficient workflow and enables the startup to grow and scale in the future.

XV. Interpretation of Results

The observations show that having a **clear team structure and well-defined roles** is important for startup success. Proper allocation of responsibilities helps improve coordination, productivity, and decision-making. A well-planned team also ensures that both technical development and business operations are managed effectively.

XVI. Conclusions

The **Digital Attendance and Productivity Tracker** people plan demonstrates that the right team with clearly defined roles is essential for successful startup implementation. By aligning human resources with the startup's objectives, the team can work efficiently to develop and deploy the product. A well-structured people plan also supports the startup's scalability and long-term growth.

XVII. Suggested Practicum Related Questions:

Note: Below are a few questions related to industry-specific higher-order thinking skills (HOT) that teachers must use to ensure students achieve the predetermined course outcomes.

1. Analyze an Embedded Engineer's role contributes to product innovation in a hardware startup.
2. Evaluate the importance of an FPGA Specialist in meeting project performance
3. Apply strategic reasoning to determine the optimal number of Business Development Managers for market expansion.
4. Create a role-mapping chart linking QA Lead responsibilities to product quality
5. Analyze the interdependencies between software and hardware engineers in the product lifecycle.
6. Evaluate Technical Support Engineer impact customer satisfaction and operational efficiency.
7. Apply competency mapping to match skill sets with critical project milestones.
8. Create a staffing plan that balances technical, managerial, and business roles for a startup.

9. Analyze potential risks of role overlap or redundancy in a small-scale engineering team.
10. Evaluate how aligning leadership roles with startup vision improves investor confidence and team performance.

XVIII References / Suggestions for further reading

- a) Entrepreneurship Development (NPTEL Course)
<https://nptel.ac.in/courses/110/107/110107152/>
- b) Strategic Management and Business Policy (NPTEL Course)
<https://nptel.ac.in/courses/110/108/110108047/>
- c) 5 BEST Sections to Start Creating Your Strategic People Plans
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y9jBJbZuHsw>
- d) Business Model Canvas Explained (Strategyzer)
<https://www.strategyzer.com/canvas/business-model-canvas>
- e) Team Management (MindTools)
<https://www.mindtools.com/caiprxt/team-management>
- f) The Lean Startup by Eric Ries (Book)
- g) Managing Social and Human Capital (Coursera)
<https://www.coursera.org/learn/wharton-social-human-capital>

XIX Suggested Assessment Scheme

The performance indicators given serve as a guideline for assessing the '*process-related skills/LOs*' (marks to be awarded in real-time in the laboratory by the faculty member, as these cannot be measured after the practicum is over) and '*product-related skills/LOs*'

Note: The weightage for the process-related skills and product-related skills will change depending on the PrO, COs, and the competency related to the concerned course.

Performance Indicators		Maximum Marks	Marks Obtained
Process related skills: 12 Marks - 40%			
1	Role Identification Accuracy	3	
2	Team Collaboration & Leadership	3	
3	Strategic Framework Application (SMART, SWOT, BSC)	3	
4	Presentation Skills & Communication	3	
Product related skills: 18 Marks - 60%			
1	Feasibility and Practicality	3	
2	Innovation in People Planning	3	
3	SMART Goal Integration	4	
4	Role Description Quality	3	
5	Document Quality, Formatting & Professionalism	3	
6	Timely Submission	2	
Total		30	

To be filled by Student:

S.No.	Name of the Student	Register No.
1	Neavis Rishva. J	URK25CS1236

To be filled by the Faculty Member:

Marks Obtained	Name and Designation of the Faculty Member	Date of Evaluation
----------------	--	--------------------

Process-Related Skills (18)	Product-Related Skills (12)	Total (30)		

